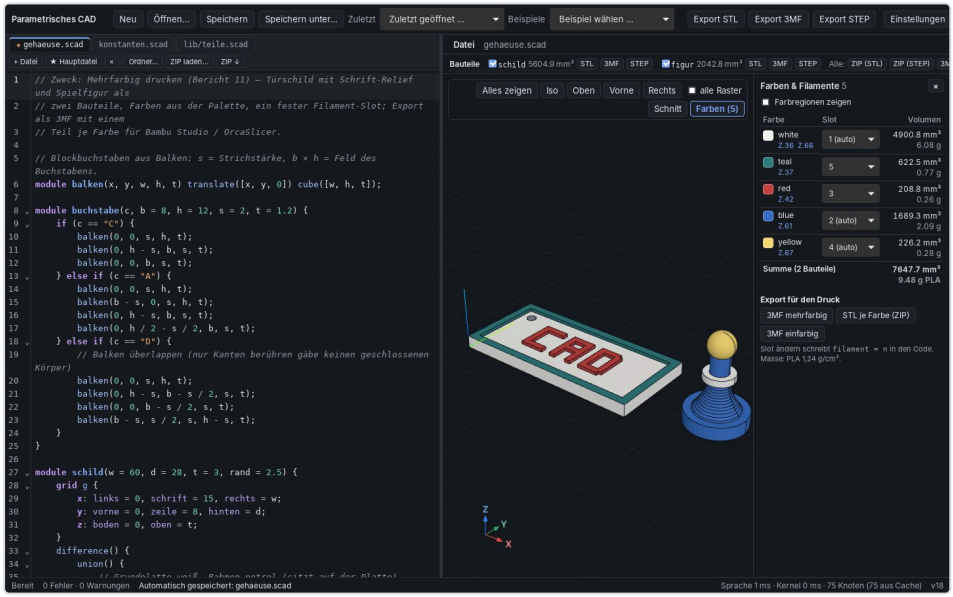
UI redesign – concept

Draft for discussion, as of 2026-10-24. Applies equally to browser and Tauri. No new features, only order, weighting and uniform controls. Questions for you on the last page.

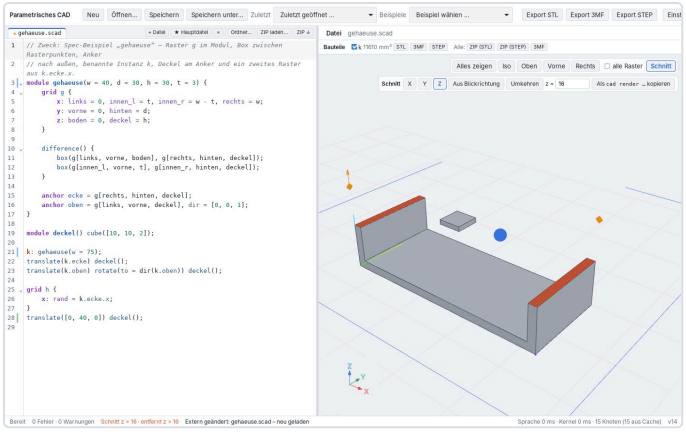
> **Decision (2026-10-24):** all proposals (option A in each case) accepted. Accent colour **not blue**, but teal/emerald (e.g. light `#0f766e`, dark `#3cc4a8`; exact values after contrast check). The drafts below still show the old blue.

1. Findings

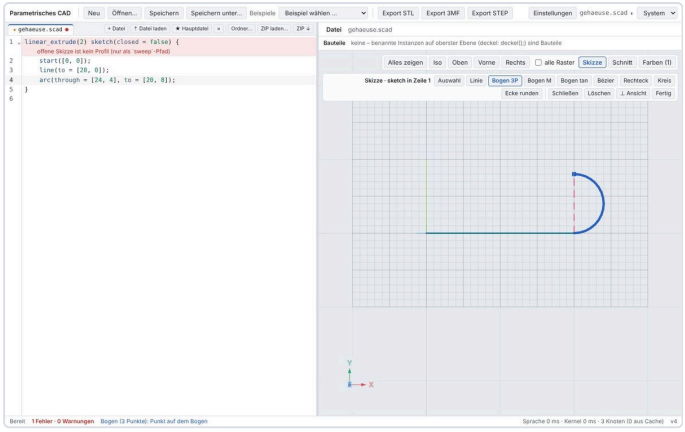
1. **Header bar:** 10+ equally weighted text buttons; „Zuletzt“ (Recent) / „Beispiele“ (Examples) as grey labels with wide drop-down lists; three separate export buttons; at 1440 px „Einstellungen“ (Settings) is cut off.
2. **Three button sizes** side by side (header bar 28 px, file bar 22 px, part export 18 px), different borders and spacing.
3. **File bar in the editor:** „+ Datei, Datei laden, Hauptdatei, ×, Ordner..., ZIP laden..., ZIP ↓“ (+ File, Load file, Main file, ×, Folder..., Load ZIP..., ZIP ↓) – seven small buttons, sometimes next to, sometimes below the tabs.
4. **Two info rows above the view** („Datei ...“ (File ...), „Bauteile ... STL 3MF STEP ... Alle: ZIP ...“ (Parts ... STL 3MF STEP ... All: ZIP ...)) cost height and mix display with export.
5. **View bar:** views, grid checkbox and modes (section, colours, sketch) mixed; wraps, floats right-aligned; sub-bars (section, sketch) appear in different places with their own width.
6. **Sketch tools** only as text, without groups; „Fertig“ (Done) looks like any other tool.
7. **Side panel** only for colours; measuring would have no room.



Current state (Tauri, dark, colours panel open).



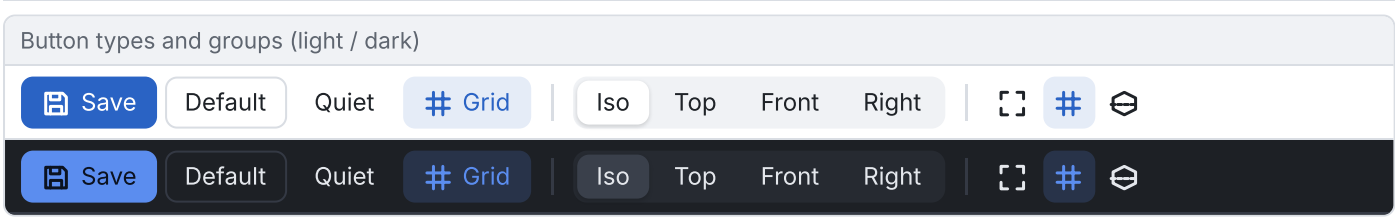
Section bar below the view bar.



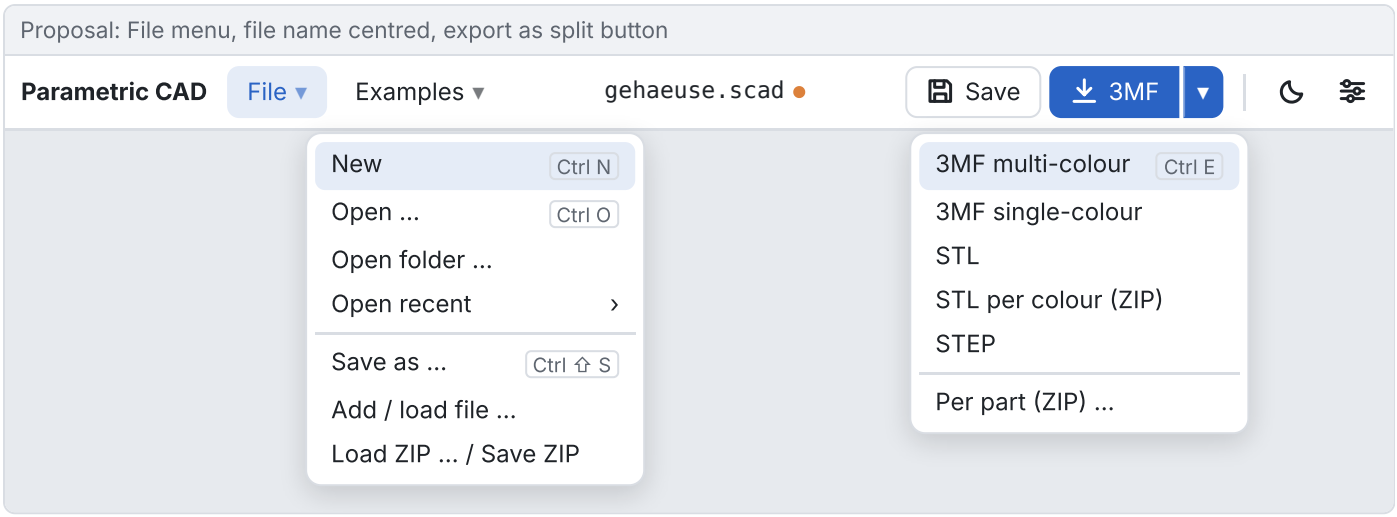
Sketch bar: 13 text buttons in two rows.

2. Rules

Topic	Rule
Button types	**Primary** (filled, at most one per area: “Save”, “Done”) · **Default** (border) · **Quiet** (no border, for toolbars) · **Toggle** (active = accent background).
Sizes	One height: 26 px. Only icon buttons square 26 × 26. Radius 6 px everywhere.
Groups	2 px within a group, separator + 12 px between groups. Exclusive choice (view, mode) as a **segmented control**.
Icons	Simple stroke icons 15 px with tooltip incl. keyboard shortcut; text only for important or rare actions. Examples here drawn by hand; in the product e.g. Lucide (ISC licence).
Rarely used	In menus (▾) instead of separate buttons: file actions, export variants, part export.
Context bar	Options of the active mode (section, sketch, measure) always **in the same place**: top left in the view, below the toolbar.
Themes	Only existing tokens; focus ring visible; contrasts still checked by `contrast.test.ts`.



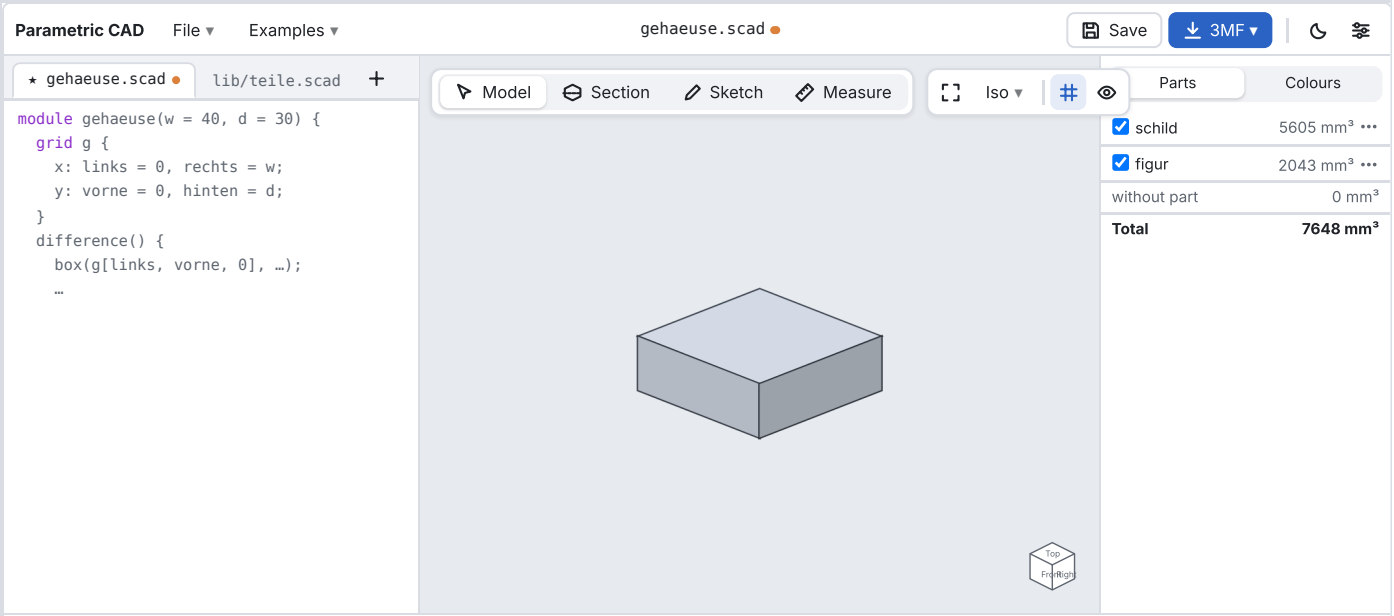
3. Header bar



“File” groups New, Open, Folder, Recent, Save as, Add, ZIP. The export button remembers the last chosen format. Theme (light/dark/system) as one icon button with a menu. The row „Datei …“ (File …) above the view is dropped (the name is shown in the header bar).

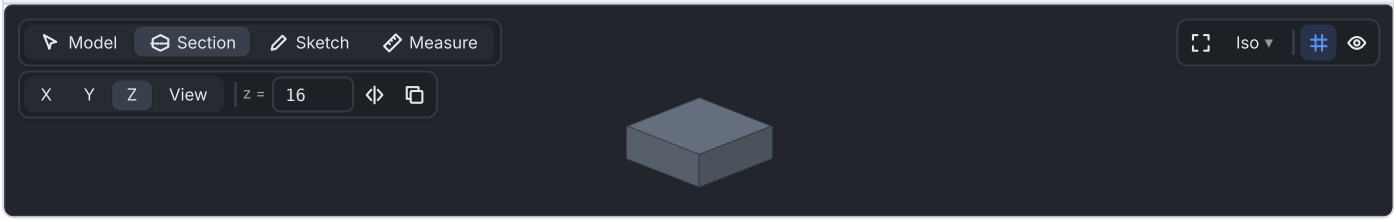
4. Overall layout

Proposal light: tabs without file buttons, one toolbar in the view, side panel with tabs



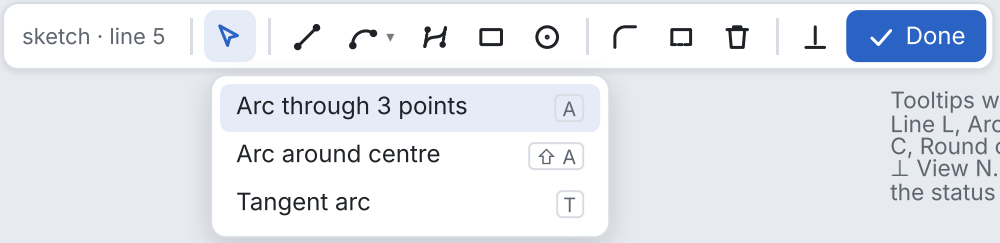
- **Editor:** tabs only; “+” at the end opens New/Load; right-click on a tab: Set as main file, Rename, Close.
- **View:** on the left the **mode** (Model, Section, Sketch, Measure – exactly one active), on the right **camera and display** (Fit, View ▾ with Iso/Top/Front/Right …, Grid, X-ray/Ghost). Clickable view cube at the bottom right instead of the axis cross (option, question 4).
- **Side panel** on the right, collapsible, tabs **Parts** (visibility, volume, export in the ⋯ menu) and **Colours** (current panel). The row „Bauteile …“ (Parts …) above the view is dropped. Measurement results will later get their own tab here.

The same in dark, mode “Section” active: context bar on the left below the toolbar



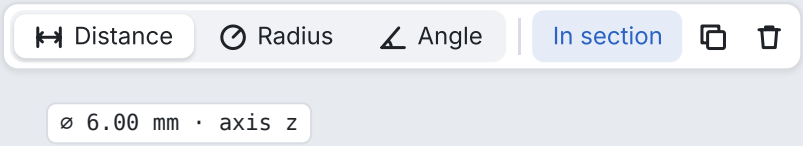
5. Context bars

Sketch: tools in groups, arc types in a submenu, “Done” as primary button



Tooltips with keyboard shortcut: Select V, Line L, Arc A, Bézier B, Rectangle R, Circle C, Round corner F, Close Enter, Delete Del, ⊥ View N. The active tool is also shown in the status bar.

Measure (for the next task, only space and operation): choose the measurement type, result in the view and in the “Measure” tab



6. Scope and verification

- Shared building blocks `Button`, `IconButton`, `Segmented`, `Menu`, `Toolbar` in `web/src/app/ui/`; move all bars onto them. No function is dropped, everything stays reachable by keyboard.
- Playwright selectors via roles/names (`aria-label` instead of button text); existing scenarios stay green; image comparison light/dark at 1280, 1440 and 1920 px, no wrapping and no clipping.
- Test report with before/after images per area.

7. Questions for you

1. Icons or text?
A Icons + tooltip in toolbars, text only for mode, Save, Export, Done (proposal) · B Icon + text everywhere (wider) · C text only, but uniform

2. File actions and export in menus?
A "File ▾" + split export button (proposal) · B Open/Save stay visible as buttons, the rest goes into the menu

3. Parts and colours in the side panel?
A Side panel with tabs, collapsible; rows above the view are dropped (proposal) · B Parts stay as a narrow row above the view

4. Views?
A View menu + clickable view cube (proposal) · B keep the segmented control Iso/Top/Front/Right visible · C both

5. Position of the toolbar?
A at the top of the view, mode on the left, camera on the right (proposal) · B vertical bar along the left edge of the view

6. Density and font?
A 26 px buttons, Inter 12 px (proposal) · B more compact (24 px) · C more generous (30 px)

7. Anything else that bothers you (e.g. editor font, colours of the view, status bar)?